Illustration with synthetic congestion and weather. Not a real forecast.

# Port Brief

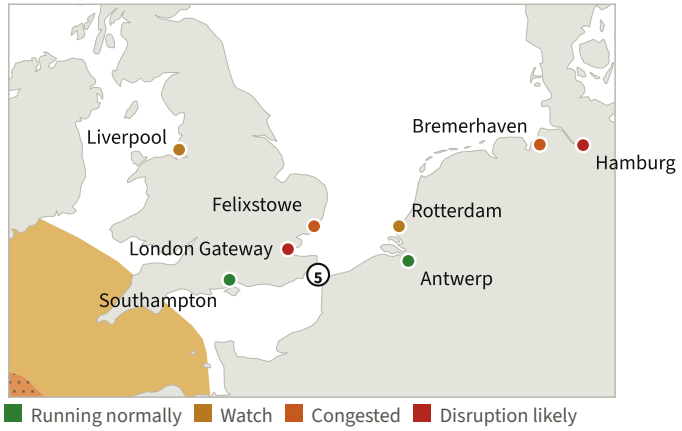
Issue 12, Sunday 11 October 2026

## Felixstowe congested as wind threatens London Gateway on Wednesday


**1** **Port health**
Felixstowe and Bremerhaven congested; London Gateway wind Wed; Hamburg strike Mon

**2** **Weather on the way in**
Severe seas in Biscay: Asia and West Africa services 1–2 days late

**3** **News and notices**
Strike reported at Hamburg for Monday


## 1 Port health check

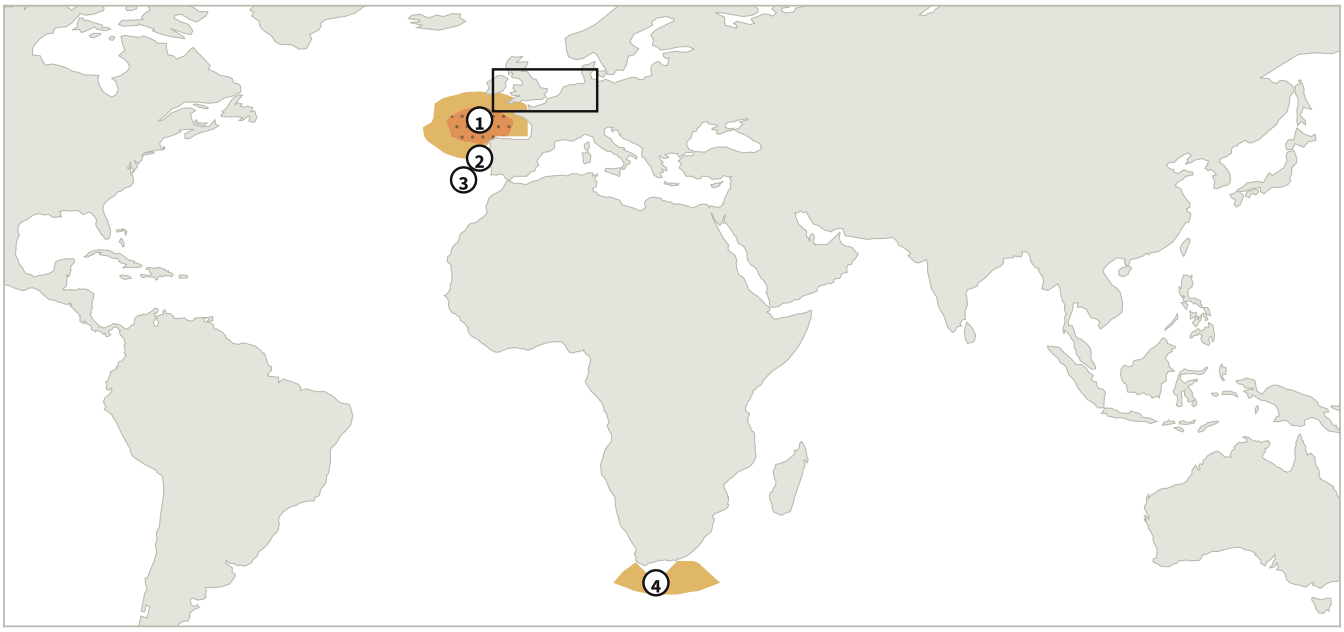
Congestion, the next seven days of weather, and what to do

| Port | Berth occupancy vs normal | Crane weather, next 7 days | What to do |
|---|---|---|---|
| *United Kingdom* | | | |
| **Felixstowe** Congested | 84%, +13 on normal · stay 38 h | M T W T F S S | Berths 13 points over normal: add 2–3 days to inland plans for the next 2 weeks |
| **Southampton** Running normally | 61%, +1 on normal · stay 22 h | M T W T F S S | No delays expected: book release and delivery now |
| **London Gateway** Disruption likely | 66%, +2 on normal · stay 25 h | M T W T F S S | Cranes likely stopped Wed 11:00–20:00: warn your haulier, allow 24–48 hours |
| **Liverpool** Watch | 58%, -3 on normal · stay 20 h | M T W T F S S | Gusty Thu morning: avoid tight Thursday cut-offs |
| *North Europe* | | | |
| **Rotterdam** Watch | 74%, +7 on normal · stay 31 h | M T W T F S S | Busier than usual: avoid tight feeder connections |
| **Antwerp** Running normally | 63%, +0 on normal · stay 28 h | M T W T F S S | No delays expected: book release and delivery now |
| **Bremerhaven** Congested | 70%, +4 on normal · stay 45 h ↑ | M T W T F S S | Ships staying 36% longer: add 2–3 days for the next 2 weeks |
| **Hamburg** Disruption likely | 68%, +3 on normal · stay 30 h | M T W T F S S | Strike reported for Monday: check terminal notices, allow 24–48 hours |

Gauge: bar is berth occupancy, black tick is the port's normal level; orange when 10 points or more above normal. Day squares: gusts near crane limits cranes likely stopped.

## 2 Weather on the way in

Rough seas on the routes into the UK, next six days




Rough 4 m+ Severe 6 m+ Extreme 8 m+ Numbers match the route strips and key below.

| Route into the UK | Sea areas along the way, origin to Channel | Delay |
|---|---|---|
| **Asia via the Cape** | S China Sea · Malacca · Sri Lanka · Indian Ocean · Cape 4 · Namibia · W Africa · Portugal 3 · Biscay 2 · W Approaches 1 · Dover 5 | **1–2 days** |
| **Asia via Suez** | S China Sea · Malacca · Sri Lanka · Arabian Sea · Aden · Red Sea · Suez · Med · Gibraltar · Portugal 3 · Biscay 2 · Dover 5 | **1–2 days** |
| **US East Coast and Canada** | NW Atlantic · Mid-Atlantic · W Approaches 1 · Dover 5 | **1–2 days** |
| **Caribbean and Panama** | Panama · Caribbean · Azores · W Approaches 1 · Dover 5 | **1–2 days** |
| **Mediterranean** | Med · Gibraltar · Portugal 3 · Biscay 2 · Dover 5 | **1–2 days** |
| **West Africa** | G of Guinea · W Africa · Portugal 3 · Biscay 2 · W Approaches 1 · Dover 5 | **1–2 days** |
| **North Sea feeders** | North Sea · German Bight · Dover 5 | **Up to 1 day** |

Confirm revised ETAs for anything routed past Biscay this week before you book haulage.

| No. | Sea area | Severity | When | Peak seas | Delay |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Western Approaches** | Severe | Wed 14 Oct | 7.3 m | 1–2 days |
| 2 | **Bay of Biscay** | Severe | Wed 14 Oct | 7.0 m | 1–2 days |
| 3 | **Off Portugal** | Severe | Wed 14 Oct | 6.6 m | 1–2 days |
| 4 | **Cape of Good Hope / Agulhas** | Rough | Wed 14 Oct | 5.4 m | Up to 1 day |
| 5 | **Dover Strait** | Rough | Wed 14 Oct | 2.2 m | Up to 1 day |

## 3 News and notices From the ports and shipping lines, past seven days

Disruption Surcharge Service change Other

### Ports

Other Smart berths: What West African ports can learn from Rotterdam
Port of Rotterdam, Thu 8 Oct · new

### Shipping lines

Surcharge Maersk raises U.S. surcharge to USD 215: what it means for Maersk stock
Maersk, Mon 12 Oct · new

Surcharge Maersk raises U.S. inland fuel surcharge to USD 215: stock pre-market at EUR 3,335.50
Maersk, Mon 12 Oct · new

Service change Agility bags EUR 500 mn financing + Damietta welcomes another MSC service
MSC, Sun 11 Oct · new

Service change MSC launches weekly feeder service to Lekki Port via Lomé
MSC, Sun 11 Oct · new

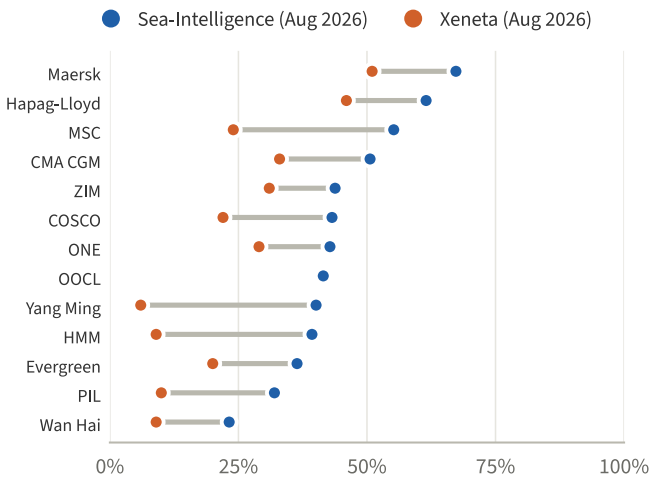
Disruption Hapag-Lloyd suspends bookings to three Philippine ports as container crisis deepens
Hapag-Lloyd, Mon 12 Oct · new

Surcharge Hapag-Lloyd adds Luanda equipment surcharge
Hapag-Lloyd, Sat 10 Oct · new

Disruption CMA CGM: Malaysia Enforces New Cargo Manifest Rules, Raising Risk of Port Delays
CMA CGM, Fri 9 Oct · new

Surcharge Nigerian Importers Face Third CMA CGM Shipping Surcharge in 2026
CMA CGM, Fri 9 Oct · new

### Shipping line reliability, Aug 2026




### What the figures mean

On time in August 2026: Sea-Intelligence 49.9%, Xeneta 29% (stricter measure).

Share of ships arriving on time. Sea-Intelligence counts arrivals within a day of schedule; Xeneta counts only arrivals on the scheduled day, so its figures run lower.

Weather flags are forecasts, not port notices. Confirm with your terminal or carrier before changing plans.

Headlines link to the original publishers; some discovered via Google News. Port congestion data: Sinay (sinay.ai). Schedule reliability: Sea-Intelligence Global Liner Performance report; Xeneta Schedule Reliability Scorecard. Tropical cyclone data: GDACS (Global Disaster Alert and Coordination System), European Commission JRC / UN OCHA. Weather data by Open-Meteo.com (CC BY 4.0). Maps use Natural Earth data.

Data this issue: weather complete; sea-state grid complete; tropical storms complete; congestion not connected; schedule reliability complete; notices complete.